



October 22nd 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UVctcWyg3xE
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 22, 2019

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order at [00:00:11](#) by the presiding officer. Opening announcements included noting that the auditor, chief deputy, and chief bookkeeper were unavailable, with Rebecca Fires stepping in to assist in the bookkeeping area due to personal and family medical emergencies.
- **Attendance:** Specific roll call details for individual council members are not fully enumerated at the opening, but participating council members referenced throughout proceedings include Jessica, Larry, Scott, and Jane.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:02:39](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The agenda as posted was approved by voice vote [00:02:48](#). Minutes from the previous meeting were subsequently approved.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:05:04 Budget Transfers: Courts to Public Defenders & Probation

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court and Probation departments.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding fund reallocations for probation officers, removal dogs, attorney fees, and salary adjustments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (recorded as passing with unanimous/affirmative votes from participating members).

00:06:42 Salary Adjustment: Council to Deputy

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for a \$2,500 salary adjustment from council to deputy.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:08:04 Sheriff<U+2019>s Department Transfers & Line Item Adjustments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff<U+2019>s Department / Emily.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers involving office supplies and equipment. The Finance Committee recommended changing line item 441 from "computer equipment" to "computer scanner equipment" (subsequently adjusted to give more flexibility for purchasing replacement chairs across parklands) and modifying line item 195/145 from "training" to "part-time" retroactive to January 1st to accommodate high turnover in the jail.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:09:06 Sheriff<U+2019>s Department Overtime Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway / Sheriff<U+2019>s Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer \$30,000 from health insurance into overtime. Approved by the Finance Committee.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:19:56 Community Corrections Transfers & New Positions

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Community Corrections / Jane.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding part-time funding and new positions, including coordination with pretrial candidate monitoring, probation services, and a newly discussed "peer recovery coach" position designed to assist offenders struggling with addiction (addressing state requirements of 200 hours of engagement for high-risk offenders). Extensive discussion ensued regarding the local and national opioid/methamphetamine epidemic, drug trafficking shifts toward crystal meth and

fentanyl, and collaboration with federal agencies (FBI, DEA). Molly Hunt from Purdue Extension also spoke regarding 4-h youth development and preventive risk behaviors.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (with amended payroll payout figures).

00:26:16 Coroner<U+2019>s Office Appropriation Request

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner's Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$100,000 for autopsies (bringing the annual total budget to approximately \$280,180) to cover rising caseloads (noting roughly 40% are overdose-related) and \$59,000 in outstanding bills. The Finance Committee discussed the necessity of these funds given the volume of coroner cases involving drugs and synthetic opioids.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:38:16 J-CAP / Grant-Funded Staffing Adjustments

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** J-CAP / Ashley.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding utilizing a Voca grant and J-CAP funds to transition three part-time grant-funded employees to full-time status (with matching benefits) and create a new full-time position. Staff are aware that if grant funding lapses in future years, positions revert to part-time or dissolve.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:45:06 Inmate Medical Care & Drug Court Grants

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Courts / Drug Court / Veterans Court.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Approval to use collected inmate medical fees for inmate medical needs, alongside Indiana Supreme Court grant appropriations for client drug screens, travel/training, and incentive programs (monthly gift card drawings for compliant participants).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:48:30 Auditor<U+2019>s Office Financial Consultant Contract

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor<U+2019>s Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of funds to hire a retired professional accounting consultant (formerly with Whiting & Associates) on a contractual basis to help the auditor<U+2019>s department establish new accounting procedures required by the State of Indiana at half the market rate charged by commercial accounting firms.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

00:51:46 Visitors Bureau Board Vacancy & New Appointment

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Council.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council addressed chronic meeting absences by appointed board member Jared Owen, whose motel management job conflicted with meeting times.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to remove Jared Owen from the Visitors Bureau board: **Approved by roll call vote.**
 - Subsequent discussion and motion to appoint a replacement web/technology professional (Victor) with digital marketing and website experience to boost the bureau's digital presence: **Approved by roll call vote** (with Victor abstaining from relevant votes).

00:59:10 Resolution 2019-34: Circuit Court 6 / Court Matters

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Council / Legal.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to take Resolution 2019-34 off the table and consider adoption regarding court administrative structures and state review board submission.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken off the table and **Approved by roll call vote** (note: one council member later requested a vote change at [01:37:54](#)).

01:02:41 County Treasurer Presentation: Hoosier Fund Investment Pool

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gerald Kain (County Treasurer) & Curt Fritch (Program Administrator, Hoosier Fund).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation on utilizing the "Hoosier Fund" a statutory money market investment pool designed for local units of government under Indiana Code 5-13 to invest idle county cash balances (such as rainy day funds) at a higher yield (~2% net of fees) compared to local banks (1.3% to 1.8%). Discussion covered fund custody (U.S. Bank), daily liquidity, statutory compliance, the Public Deposit Insurance Fund (PDIF) protections, and comparison with historical investments.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Taken under advisement for further review and digestion by council members prior to formal action.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No formal citizen public comment session was conducted during this segment; board members and presenters discussed community items such as the 4-h annual dinner and the Indiana Blood Bank donation needs.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Mention of upcoming community events, the 4-h annual dinner attendance, and blood donation drives at the local mall.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following general board announcements and voting revisions 01:40:24.
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